A-A-51513B
3 August 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-51513A
2 October 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CATHETER AND CONNECTOR, SUCTION, TRACHEAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

The commercial item description covers a various sized tracheal suction and catheters and connectors.

Salient Characteristics.

The catheter and connector shall be a sterile, disposable unit suitable for suction procedures through tracheal airways.

Catheter. The catheter shall be transparent and fabricated of flexible polyvinylchloride in accordance with the USP for Class II plastics. The proximal end of the catheter shall be permanently attached to the connector. The distal end shall have a whistle tip and at lest two oval-shaped side eyes. The catheter shall have a minimum tensile strength of 1500 psig and minimum elongation of 200 percent and a Shore A Durometer hardness of 70 to 85.

Connector. The connector shall be fabricated of a rigid plastic in accordance with the USP for Class II plastics. The connector shall be tapered for airtight connection to flexible tubing of 1/4 inch inside diameter. At least four equally spaced rings shall circumscribe the tapered end of the connector for security of attachment to the tubing. The connector shall have a thumb port which opens into the lumen to allow manual control of suction pressure. The cross-sectional area of the port opening shall be at least 1.5 times that of the catheter lumen.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sizes. Catheters shall be provided in the following sizes, as specified:

6, 8, 10, 14, 18 French

The minimum length of 6 and 8 French catheters, exclusive of the connector, shall be 15.5 inches. The minimum length of 10, 14, and 18 French catheters, exclusive of the connector, shall be 18.5 inches. The style and design of the catheter and connector shall be as in Figure 1.

The catheter and connector shall meet the requirements of the USP for Sterility, pyrogenicity, and safety.

Workmanship. The finished catheter and connector shall be free from loose flash, cracks, burrs, or sharp edges.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 50 individually packaged catheters constitutes one unit. Each catheter shall be packaged straight (not coiled) in a sealed peel-open type container capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless the container is damaged or opened.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means and chemical properties) of the item.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more tests characteristics.

Security of assembly. The catheter shall not loose or separate from the connector when the specified load is applied vertically for 5 minutes from the distal end of the catheter while the connector is held in a suitable clamping device.

French size	Load (lbs.
6	4
8	4
10	5
14	5
18	5

Tensile strength and minimum elongation shall be tested in accordance with ASTM Designation D638.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-1 and acceptance number zero. Sampling for sterility shall be in accordance with the USP. The unit of product for tests purposes shall be one catheter and connector.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers'own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and /or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-458-8411	CATHETER AND CONNECTOR, SUCTION, ENDOTRACHEAL, Plastic, Disposable, 14 French, 50s
6515-00-458-8413	CATHETER AND CONNECTOR, SUCTION, ENDOTRACHEAL, Plastic, Disposable, 10 French, 50s
6515-00-458-8414	CATHETER AND CONNECTOR, SUCTION, ENDOTRACHEAL, Plastic, Disposable, 8 French, 50s

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6515-00-458-8415	CATHETER AND CONNECTOR, SUCTION, ENDOTRACHEAL, Plastic, Disposable, 6 French, 50s
6515-00-458-8416	CATHETER AND CONNECTOR, SUCTION, ENDOTRACHEAL, Plastic, Disposable, 18 French, 50s

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4964

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

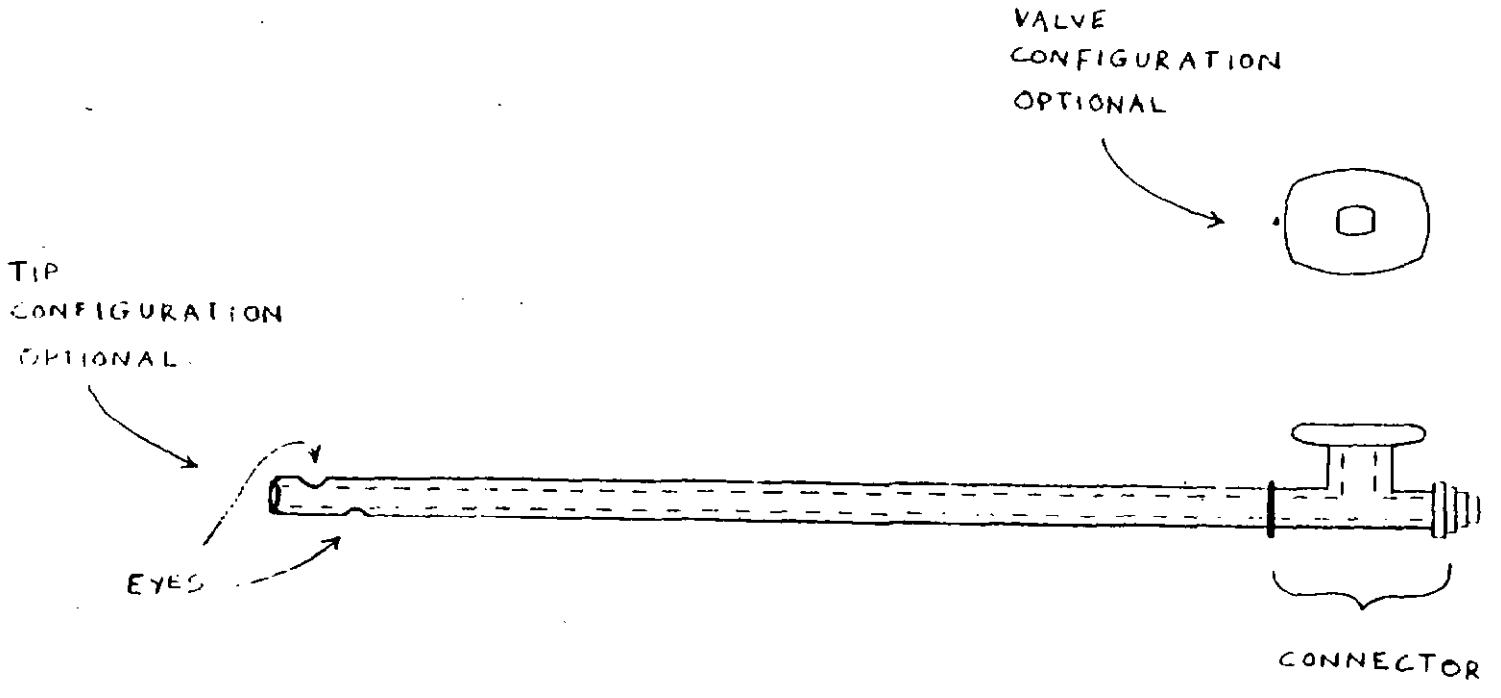


FIGURE 1: CATHETER AND CONNECTOR, SUCTION, TRACHEAL

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51513B	CATHETER AND CONNECTOR, SUCTION, TRACHEAL

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

DD FORM 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 4966 Alexandria, VA

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:57Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.